

OVERVIEW

LMS VIA MICROSOFT AUTOMATION



Building an LMS using the M365 Environment

Most organizations need an LMS to support:



Content Sharing



Automated
Registration and
Certification



Tracking and
Reporting

There are third party applications available through M365 that can support these functions, but they require subscriptions and admin permissions that might not be allowed by your local IT policies.



Since the M365 suite of tools are all interconnected, they will do most of this for you. It also allows for multiple ways to configure the process to help account for internal and external stakeholders.



Outlook, OneDrive, and SharePoint serve as foundational elements that help interconnect the rest of the tool that you will need. They become the backbone for sharing and saving information.



Information collected in Forms drives data collection for registration, course completion quizzes, and course evaluations.



PowerAutomate Flows can be triggered by spreadsheet data created by Forms. This can be used to:



Generate PDF certificates that are delivered by email (Outlook) or inform users of a need to retake a Quiz



Save course completion documentation and data to OneDrive for use by other processes



Create and update entries in Lists on SharePoint to document task or progress status



Trigger multiple notification types to administrators and end users.

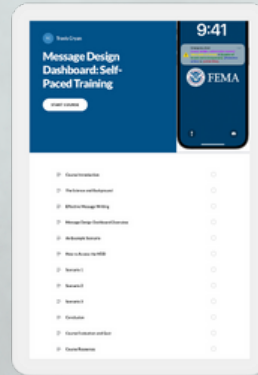
Teams can also serve as the information hub for:

- Administrators to share information and training
- End users to consume training or track their progress toward credentialing

An Example of LMS Automation using M365

Over 1200 students from across the country have used an automated process to complete the “Effective Message Writing and the Message Design Dashboard” Training. The effort began in late 2023 and is still in progress. The class is now FULLY automated, but in the initial stages it was hybrid course that required multiple touchpoints with the system. This is described below:

Initial Self-Paced Course



Students accessed a publicly available link to complete a SP course that contained all of the core course content.



The SP Course contained TWO embedded Forms.

- One captured initial information about the student
- The final one served as a Quiz and Course Eval.



If the student passed the Quiz, PowerAutomate generated a PDF certificate and sent the student an email that contained the certificate and information on how to register for the Instructor-Led Skills portion of the class. Quiz completion was the only way to register for the next step.

If the Quiz was not passed, an email was triggered with information on how to retake it.

Instructor-Led Skills Sessions



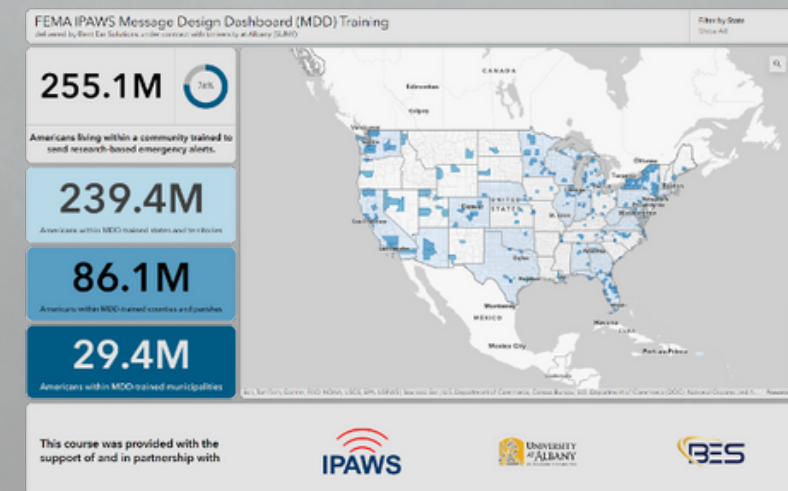
In the initial months of the course, it was necessary to attend an Instructor-Led session (In-Person or Virtual) to obtain access to a live version of the Message Design Dashboard (MDD). Registration for this was conducted through Teams Webinar or Forms depending on the format.



In both formats, students were given access to an Online Student Guide that contained scenarios and embedded Forms to capture real-time responses. This tool also provided access to embedded Course Evaluations and the Final Exam.



As with the SP Course, the Quiz results triggered a certificate creation, delivery, and storage process.



The data that was collected on students who completed the course was used to populate an ESRI Dashboard to help demonstrate the reach of the training.

Potential Project Approach

Confidential

Project Description: The Sacramento County Office of Emergency Services is seeking to integrate process for a Learning Management System (LMS) into their existing M365/Teams environment to support training delivery, tracking, reporting, and credentialing in a way that is efficient, affordable, and accessible to internal and external stakeholders. Below is one approach to designing and launching such a program:

Discovery and Planning

-  Define course types to be delivered and short/long term program goal
-  Coordinate with IT to understand available M365 licenses, permissions, policies, and tolerances
-  Evaluate other tools or applications, as allowed, that might be available for integration into this process
-  Identify or request a master user account
-  Upgrade any required licenses or permissions, or identify appropriate alternate options
-  Identify data and information to be collected, how it can be collected, and how it needs to be used
-  Perform process mapping and function testing

Set-Up and Testing

-  Configure initial tools, storage locations, and products
-  Set-up basic processes and test
-  Combine processes steps and test
-  Configure data tracking and reporting elements
-  Configure administrative views and tools
-  Configure end user views and tools
-  Develop initial rollout plan and identify material and scheduling needs
-  Develop initial instructions and materials to support rollout

Initial Deployment

-  Finalize job aids and documentation
-  Prepare training and/or webinar material on use
-  Operationalize for internal personnel
-  Obtain feedback on initial launch and consider need for immediate or future revisions
-  Troubleshoot any errors or malfunctions
-  Develop plan for next steps or enhancements
-  Ensure program staff have complete training and documentation for managing and maintaining tools and processes

Expanded Deployment TBD

Rough Time and Cost Estimate

-  A project of this scope would likely take between **three and six months** to complete based on:
 - The general steps outlined
 - Flexibility of the IT program and policies

-  The cost of a project of this scope, completed by one consultant with support from client staff would likely be:
Low: \$20,000.00
High: \$30,000.00

-  *Final cost would be based on:*
 - Finalized proposal scope
 - Required completion timeline
 - Client cost tolerances

I strive for flexibility and client success to build sustainable programs. I will work with you to develop the most appropriate and affordable approach for your program.